

expenditures for her business. She realizes that the same system she used for business accounting can be used for domestic purposes. This is an advantage of being a self-employed business owner.

Mrs. Rule wants to be free of financial worry before her sixty-fifth birthday. Each time she tabulates, she tells herself she is reducing her fear of never being able to retire in comfort. Who has concern about their financial future? Not Mrs. Rule. Although she has an annual income of \$90,000, she's worth more than twenty times that amount. And she is in control of her household's domestic spending.

Robert and Judy, on the other hand, are frightened. And they should be. This couple earns \$200,000 annually, or more than twice what Mrs. Rule earns. Yet, like so many of today's high-income-producing couples, Robert and Judy have only a fraction of Mrs. Rule's wealth. They feel that consumption controls them, not the other way around. Even Mrs. Rule might find it daunting to have to account for \$200,000 in expenditures each year. Robert and Judy have fourteen credit cards; the Rules have two (one for business use, the other for domestic spending).

Let's talk about credit cards for a moment. Ask a large sample of millionaires a simple question about their credit cards. The results will give you an excellent idea of who these millionaires really are.

Mr./Mrs. Millionaire:

Please indicate, by circling the appropriate number, the credit cards that you or any member of your house possesses. Circle all those that apply.

Now close your eyes and pretend you are a millionaire with a net worth of nearly \$4 million. What credit cards would be congruent with your station in life? Perhaps at the top of your list would be American Express Platinum, Diners Club, or Carte Blanche. Perhaps you consider yourself a fashion-sensitive millionaire. You may list credit cards from Brooks Brothers, Neiman Marcus, Saks Fifth Avenue, Lord & Taylor, or even Eddie Bauer. You would be in the minority of millionaires if you did list these cards. The results from our national survey of millionaires reveal some interesting credit card preferences (see [Table 2-2](#)). Some highlights: